

LIVE

Learning Space

NEWSPAPER

10th August, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

32nd WEEK



ISOLATION OF IRAN

**UPSC CSE –
GS II**

**GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPED AND
DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.**

2

Rouhani's challenge

Iran's President begins his second term in daunting circumstances at home and abroad

Hassan Rouhani has formally begun his second term as Iran's President in especially challenging circumstances. Conservatives at home are pushing for a hard-line agenda, Sunni states in the Gulf are consolidating a regional alliance against Shia-majority Iran, and the U.S. is turning up the heat on the country's missile programme. Mr. Rouhani, who won the election on a moderate platform, had drawn hope during his campaign that he would build on the momentum his first term had generated and initiate social reform. It was never going to be easy, given the resolve of the clerical establishment to push back any major attempt to change the *status quo*. In Iran's complex, multipolar political system, the President runs the government with a popular mandate but the security establishment reports directly to the Supreme Leader, who can override the government on critical issues. What Mohammad Khatami tried and failed and what Mr. Rouhani tested during his first term was to gradually push pragmatic policies, overcoming the conservative opposition. Mr. Rouhani's decision to go ahead with the nuclear deal despite concerns from the establishment was an example of his successful brinkmanship. The expectation was that in his second term, Mr. Rouhani would expand the reform agenda into domestic politics. The reformists have many demands.

However, one of the first decisions Mr. Rouhani has taken in the new term raises questions about his resolve to initiate meaningful reforms. On Tuesday, he nominated an all-men cabinet, which needs to be approved by Parliament. The chances of women nominees getting through the parliamentary process were high this time given that reformists and moderates make up a majority in the Majlis. Still, Mr. Rouhani preferred not to take the risk of antagonising conservatives. To be sure, these are hard times for a moderate President in Iran. The nuclear deal, the signature achievement of Mr. Rouhani's first term, is under attack, with U.S. President Donald Trump threatening to cancel its certification. With the U.S. imposing more sanctions on Iran over the missile programme and joining hands with its regional rivals such as Saudi Arabia, conservative sections find their hard-line views vindicated and would like Tehran to reciprocate in the same tenor. Mr. Rouhani may therefore have preferred to avoid a clash within the system over his cabinet nominations. It is not clear to what extent he may sacrifice the reformist agenda under pressure from hardliners. His supporters will hope that he will come around to simultaneously pursuing a pragmatic reformist agenda at home and a realistic foreign policy that doesn't succumb to external provocations. Only then would Hassan Rouhani live up to the expectations of the millions of Iranians who re-elected him.

THE  HINDU

Date : 10th August, 2017

2

Rouhani's challenge

Iran's President begins his second term in daunting circumstances at home and abroad

Hassan Rouhani has formally begun his second term as Iran's President in especially challenging circumstances. Conservatives at home are pushing for a hard-line agenda, Sunni states in the Gulf are consolidating a regional alliance against Shia-majority Iran, and the U.S. is turning up the heat on the country's missile programme. Mr. Rouhani, who won the election on a moderate platform, had drawn hope during his campaign that he would build on the momentum his first term had generated and initiate social reform. It was never going to be easy, given the resolve of the clerical establishment to push back any major attempt to change the *status quo*. In Iran's complex, multipolar political system, the President runs the government with a popular mandate but the security establishment reports directly to the Supreme Leader, who can override the government on critical issues. What Mohammad Khatami tried and failed and what Mr. Rouhani tested during his first term was to gradually push pragmatic policies, overcoming the conservative opposition. Mr. Rouhani's decision to go ahead with the nuclear deal despite concerns from the establishment was an example of his successful brinkmanship. The expectation was that in his second term, Mr. Rouhani would expand the reform agenda into domestic politics. The reformists have many demands.

However, one of the first decisions Mr. Rouhani has taken in the new term raises questions about his resolve to initiate meaningful reforms. On Tuesday, he nominated an all-men cabinet, which needs to be approved by Parliament. The chances of women nominees getting through the parliamentary process were high this time given that reformists and moderates make up a majority in the Majlis. Still, Mr. Rouhani preferred not to take the risk of antagonising conservatives. To be sure, these are hard times for a moderate President in Iran. The nuclear deal, the signature achievement of Mr. Rouhani's first term, is under attack, with U.S. President Donald Trump threatening to cancel its certification. With the U.S. imposing more sanctions on Iran over the missile programme and joining hands with its regional rivals such as Saudi Arabia, conservative sections find their hard-line views vindicated and would like Tehran to reciprocate in the same tenor. Mr. Rouhani may therefore have preferred to avoid a clash within the system over his cabinet nominations. It is not clear to what extent he may sacrifice the reformist agenda under pressure from hardliners. His supporters will hope that he will come around to simultaneously pursuing a pragmatic reformist agenda at home and a realistic foreign policy that doesn't succumb to external provocations. Only then would Hassan Rouhani live up to the expectations of the millions of Iranians who re-elected him.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS?

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

With Donald Trump as new President of USA, Iran is being isolated with more and more sanctions. This emboldened GCC countries, especially Saudi Arabia and discuss its geo-political implications on India?



**ALI KHAMENEI**

Supreme Leader, Iran

**HASSAN ROUHANI**

President, Iran

NEWS REPORT

- 1 In Iran, President Hassan Rouhani, began his second term under challenging circumstances.
- 2 He has to toe a balancing stance with the conservatives pushing for hard line agenda and the Supreme Leader enjoying certain powers as far as security establishment is concerned.



ALI KHAMENEI
Supreme Leader, Iran



HASSAN ROUHANI
President, Iran

STRUCTURE OF GOVERNANCE IN IRAN

- 1 The country has got a system of Supreme Leader, where security establishment directly reports to the Supreme Leader, who can overwrite the Government on critical issues.
- 2 There are several conservative elements, which push for hard line agenda.
- 3 The country is the de-facto head of Shias in the world.
- 4 It maintains Shia militias in several countries and it also supports indirectly, the issues pertaining to Shia's like Houthi's in Yemen as well as Shia Alawite Government in Syria.

WHAT ARE THE PRESENT CHALLENGES HE IS REQUIRED TO FACE?



ALI KHAMENEI
Supreme Leader, Iran



HASSAN ROUHANI
President, Iran

- 1 Sunni states in the Gulf are consolidating a regional alliance against Shia majority Iran.
- 2 Conservatives within the country are pushing for hard line agenda.

- 3 US imposed sanctions against the missile programme of Iran.
- 4 US President threatening to cancel its certification for the Nuclear deal.
- 5 US is joining hands with regional rivals, such as Saudi Arabia,
- 6 Powerful Supreme Leader some times under the influence of conservatives.

WE EXPRESS OUR SINCERE THANKS FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

D. Sunil Kumar

V. Dayakar James

Y. Sri Poojita

G. Ravi Babu

D. Joji

K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 - 2 4 4 4 7 2

0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9